W45

DECODE UPSC with Mounika

November 1st Week 2026: Practice Set

15 Prelims MCQs · 6 Mains questions with answer outlines · Mon 2 – Sat 7 Nov 2026

How to use: attempt all 15 MCQs in 15 minutes without looking at the answers, then check them against the key at the end. Then write one Mains answer: 150 words in 7 minutes, or 250 words in 11 minutes.

Part A · Prelims MCQs

1. Agnipath #UPSC-Pre #CAPF

Consider the following statements about the changes to the Agnipath scheme approved in November 2026:
1. About three in four Agniveers will get two more years of service after their first four years.
2. Entry into the armed forces will no longer be through the four-year Agniveer route.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only (c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

2. Green crackers #UPSC-Pre #UPSC-Mains-GS3

Consider the following pairs:

Institution	Role regarding green crackers
1. National Environmental Engineering Research Institute, Nagpur	Developed the green-cracker formulations
2. Petroleum and Explosives Safety Organisation	Licenses the manufacturers
3. Petroleum and Explosives Safety Organisation	Works under the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change

How many of the pairs given above are correctly matched?
(a) Only one (b) Only two (c) All three (d) None

3. Two-child rule #UPSC-Pre #APPSC-G1-Pre #TGPSC-G1-Pre

Statement-I: In November 2026, the Supreme Court referred its 2003 judgment in *Javed v. State of Haryana* to a larger bench.
Statement-II: Article 243F of the Constitution allows a State law to lay down disqualifications for membership of a panchayat.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?
(a) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct, and Statement-II explains Statement-I
(b) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct, but Statement-II does not explain Statement-I
(c) Statement-I is correct, but Statement-II is incorrect
(d) Statement-I is incorrect, but Statement-II is correct

4. Article 22 #UPSC-Pre #APPSC-G1-Pre #TGPSC-G1-Pre

With reference to Article 22(2) of the Constitution of India, which one of the following statements is correct?
(a) The 24-hour period is counted from the time the arrest is formally recorded.
(b) The 24-hour period is counted from the moment of detention, excluding the time of the journey to the magistrate.
(c) Its safeguards apply equally to persons held under preventive detention.
(d) Its safeguards are available to citizens of India only.

5. Fast-track special courts #UPSC-Pre

Consider the following statements:
1. The fast-track special courts scheme has been extended until 31 March 2031.
2. The number of courts under the scheme has been reduced from 850 to 779.
3. These courts were created by a separate Act of Parliament to hear cases under the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences Act only.

How many of the statements given above are correct?
(a) Only one (b) Only two (c) All three (d) None

6. Rural jobs law #UPSC-Pre #AP-G2 #TS-G2

Consider the following statements about the Viksit Bharat Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin) Act:
1. It guarantees 125 days of wage employment to a rural household in a financial year.
2. For most States, the Centre and the State share the cost in the ratio 60 : 40.
3. Under its Grievance Redressal Rules, 2026, a complaint must be resolved within 15 days.

How many of the statements given above are correct?
(a) Only one (b) Only two (c) All three (d) None

7. Energy storage #UPSC-Pre #RBI-ESI

Under the viability gap funding scheme for grid-scale energy storage approved in November 2026, which one of the following is planned to form the largest share of the 92 gigawatt-hours?
(a) Battery energy storage systems
(b) Pumped storage projects
(c) Green hydrogen storage
(d) Compressed air storage

8. Critical minerals #UPSC-Pre #UPSC-Mains-GS3

Statement-I: In November 2026, the Union Cabinet approved capital support for lithium and nickel processing plants in India.
Statement-II: The global processing of critical minerals is concentrated in a few countries.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?
(a) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct, and Statement-II explains Statement-I
(b) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct, but Statement-II does not explain Statement-I
(c) Statement-I is correct, but Statement-II is incorrect
(d) Statement-I is incorrect, but Statement-II is correct

9. VISTAR and the censuses #UPSC-Pre #EPFO #RBI-ESI

Consider the following statements:
1. The Economic Census is conducted by the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation.
2. The Population Census is conducted by the Registrar General and Census Commissioner under the Ministry of Home Affairs.
3. The VISTAR scheme approved in November 2026 aims to modernise India’s statistical system.

How many of the statements given above are correct?
(a) Only one (b) Only two (c) All three (d) None

10. Aviation law #UPSC-Pre

Consider the following statements:
1. The Bharatiya Vayuyan Adhiniyam, 2024 replaced the Aircraft Act, 1934.
2. The Bharatiya Vayuyan Niyam, 2026 will replace the Aircraft Rules, 1937 from 1 January 2027.
3. The new rules bar the government from intervening in air fares under any circumstances.

How many of the statements given above are correct?
(a) Only one (b) Only two (c) All three (d) None

11. Missiles #UPSC-Pre #CAPF

Consider the following pairs:

Missile	Type
1. Pralay	Quasi-ballistic
2. BrahMos	Cruise
3. Prithvi	Cruise
4. Agni	Ballistic

How many of the pairs given above are correctly matched?
(a) Only one (b) Only two (c) Only three (d) All four

12. Malabar #UPSC-Pre #CAPF

Arrange the following events in chronological order:
1. Japan becomes a permanent member of Exercise Malabar.
2. Australia rejoins Exercise Malabar.
3. Malabar begins as a bilateral India–United States exercise.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:
(a) 3 – 1 – 2 (b) 1 – 3 – 2 (c) 3 – 2 – 1 (d) 2 – 3 – 1

13. Legislatures compared #UPSC-Pre #APPSC-G1-Pre #TGPSC-G1-Pre

Consider the following statements:
1. Members of the United States Senate and members of the Rajya Sabha both serve six-year terms.
2. The Rajya Sabha can be dissolved by the President on the advice of the Prime Minister.
3. Members of the United States House of Representatives are elected for two years.

How many of the statements given above are correct?
(a) Only one (b) Only two (c) All three (d) None

14. Child rights #UPSC-Pre #APPSC-G1-Pre

The National Commission for Protection of Child Rights is:
(a) a constitutional body
(b) a statutory body set up under the Commissions for Protection of Child Rights Act, 2005
(c) an executive body under the Ministry of Home Affairs
(d) a body set up under the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences Act, 2012

15. Cancer medicines #UPSC-Pre #UPSC-Mains-GS2

Consider the following statements:
1. The National Pharmaceutical Pricing Authority works under the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare.
2. From 9 November 2026, trade margins on 137 anti-cancer medicines are capped at 30 per cent.
3. National Cancer Awareness Day is observed on 7 November, Marie Curie’s birthday.
4. Marie Curie won Nobel Prizes in two different sciences, Physics and Chemistry.

How many of the statements given above are correct?
(a) Only one (b) Only two (c) Only three (d) All four

Answer key with reasons

Q	Answer	Why
1	(a)	The scheme was modified, not scrapped; entry is still the four-year Agniveer route.
2	(b)	Pairs 1 and 2 are correct. The Petroleum and Explosives Safety Organisation works under the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (Commerce and Industry Ministry).
3	(b)	Both are true. The reference came from falling fertility and the question of reproductive choice under Article 21, not from Article 243F. The Court has not struck the rule down.
4	(b)	The Court (5 Nov 2026) held that the clock starts at detention. Article 22(3) excludes enemy aliens and preventive detention, and the Article also protects non-citizens.
5	(a)	Only statement 1 is correct. The number of courts goes up from 779 to 850, and the courts hear rape cases as well as cases under the child-protection Act, under a centrally sponsored scheme.
6	(c)	All three are correct; 90 : 10 applies to the Himalayan and north-eastern States.
7	(b)	60 gigawatt-hours pumped storage, 30 battery, 2 new technologies.
8	(a)	Concentration of processing abroad is the government’s stated reason for the scheme.
9	(c)	All three are correct. The Economic Census counts non-farm establishments.
10	(b)	Statement 3 is wrong: the rules let the government step in on fares in extraordinary situations.
11	(c)	Prithvi is a ballistic missile, not a cruise missile.
12	(a)	1992 (India–United States), then 2015 (Japan permanent), then 2020 (Australia rejoins).
13	(b)	The Rajya Sabha is a permanent body and is never dissolved; about a third of its members retire every two years.

Q	Answer	Why
14	(b)	It is a statutory body under the 2005 Act, under the Ministry of Women and Child Development.
15	(c)	Statement 1 is wrong: the authority works under the Department of Pharmaceuticals, Ministry of Chemicals and Fertilizers.

Part B · Mains questions with answer outlines

M1. Article 22 (GS-2 · 10 marks · 150 words) #UPSC-Mains-GS2 #APPSC-G1-Mains-P2

"The protection of Article 22(2) is real only if the 24-hour clock runs from the moment liberty is curtailed." Discuss in the light of a recent Supreme Court judgment.
- **Introduction:** Article 22(2) requires production before a magistrate within 24 hours, excluding the journey; it is a check on police custody.
- **Body:**
- The November 2026 ruling: no distinction between arrest and detention, and the clock starts at detention. It overruled three High Courts and ordered the release of the accused in a Tripura drug case.
- Why it matters: it closes the "informal detention" loophole and keeps judicial oversight from the first hour.
- Limits: Article 22(3) excludes preventive detention and enemy aliens.
- The burden falls on magistrates' remand scrutiny and on police record-keeping.
- **Conclusion:** liberty is measured from the first hour of custody. Better record-keeping and training of magistrates make the ruling work.

M2. Two-child rule (GS-2 / GS-1 · 15 marks · 250 words) #UPSC-Mains-GS2 #APPSC-G1-Mains-P2 #TGPSC-G1-Mains-P3

With India's fertility now below replacement level, examine whether disqualifying candidates with more than two children from panchayat elections is still justified. Should population policy rely on incentives or penalties?
- **Introduction:** India's total fertility rate is 1.9 (Sample Registration System, 2023), against a replacement level of 2.1; the Supreme Court has referred *Javed* (2003) to a larger bench.
- **Body:**
- The case for such laws: Article 243F lets States set disqualifications, and *Javed* upheld them as population control.
- The case against:
- reproductive choice under Article 21;
- an unequal effect on women and poorer households;
- fertility has already fallen without penalties.
- The Telugu states: Andhra Pradesh scrapped the rule in 2024 and Telangana for rural bodies in 2026.
- Incentives (education, health, women's work) versus penalties.
- **Conclusion:** demographic transition calls for rights-based incentives, not electoral penalties. The larger bench's ruling will settle the constitutional question.

M3. Green crackers (GS-2 / GS-3 · 10 marks · 150 words) #UPSC-Mains-GS2 #UPSC-Mains-GS3

How has the Supreme Court balanced the freedom of religion with the right to clean air in regulating firecrackers? Discuss.
- **Introduction:** the Court's order of 2 November 2026 allowed only certified green crackers in Delhi-NCR, with time windows.
- **Body:**
- Article 25 is subject to public order, morality and health.
- Article 21 includes the right to a healthy environment.
- The tools the Court used:
- time windows;
- 300-metre silence zones;
- certification (the Nagpur research institute) and licensing (the explosives safety organisation).

- The enforcement gaps: fake “green” labels and enforcement across State borders.
- **Conclusion:** harmonise faith and health through technology and enforcement, not a blanket choice between them.

M4. Energy transition (GS-3 · 15 marks · 250 words) #UPSC-Mains-GS3 #RBI-ESI

“Storage and processed critical minerals are the missing links of India’s energy transition.” Discuss with reference to the schemes approved by the Union Cabinet in November 2026.
- **Introduction:** solar power is abundant only by day, and batteries depend on minerals processed abroad.
- **Body:**
- Storage: viability gap funding of ₹14,500 crore for 92 gigawatt-hours (60 pumped storage, 30 battery, 2 new). Viability gap funding makes useful but loss-making projects viable.
- Minerals: ₹2,814 crore for a 30% capital subsidy to 2 lithium and 2 nickel processing plants. Recycling has a separate ₹1,500 crore scheme (2025).
- The challenges:
- the ecological footprint of pumped storage;
- access to ore;
- technology;
- the cost of finance.
- **Conclusion:** link the chain (storage → batteries → minerals) through mineral partnerships abroad, recycling and domestic research.

M5. Agnipath (GS-3 · 10 marks · 150 words) #UPSC-Mains-GS3 #CAPF

Examine the November 2026 changes to the Agnipath scheme. How do they balance a younger armed force against the retention of experience?
- **Introduction:** the scheme began in June 2022: entry at 17½–21, a four-year term, and about 25% retained.
- **Body:**
- The change: about 75% get two more years, with higher pay, an enhanced Seva Nidhi and a pathway to regular enrolment, subject to selection.
- The gains: combat experience is retained, and the training investment is recovered.
- The concerns: pension and salary costs, uncertainty in the cadre, and morale.
- **Conclusion:** a calibrated middle path; review it after the first batch completes its extended service.

M6. Rural jobs law (GS-2 · 10 marks · 150 words) #UPSC-Mains-GS2 #AP-G2 #TS-G2

“Grievance redressal is the real test of a rights-based welfare law.” Discuss with reference to the Grievance Redressal Rules, 2026 under the new rural employment law.
- **Introduction:** the Viksit Bharat Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin) Act replaced the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act from 1 July 2026; the guarantee is 125 days.
- **Body:**
- The rules: enquiry within 7 working days and resolution within 15, at three tiers (Gram Panchayat, Block, District), with complaints in any mode.
- Accountability: social audits; united Andhra Pradesh’s audit society dates from 2009.
- The concerns: 60 : 40 cost-sharing may strain State finances, and normative allocation may replace demand.
- **Conclusion:** timelines need independent monitoring and compensation for delay to make the right enforceable.

All facts are verified in `01-research-brief.md` (§3, §5 and §6). Questions marked UPSC-format are practice questions written for this channel, not previous-year questions.